

Willian Vieira PhD

Data analyst and modelling specialist with a PhD in quantitative ecology. I build mathematical and statistical models using reproducible data workflows that turn complex data into validated, explainable outputs for operational decisions.

DATA SCIENCE & ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

2025
|
2024
(1 yr 9 m)

• Data Analyst & developer

Habitat, Montreal, Canada

Built Python/R analytical pipelines and data-processing workflows that turned messy real-world project data into standardized, validated model inputs, reports, and decision-ready outputs | Developed metadata-driven ETL, data modelling, and provenance workflows so datasets, definitions, analyses, and handoffs remained traceable, reproducible, and inspectable | Led the transition to a Unix-based production environment using Docker, CI/CD, automated testing, documentation, and collaborative development practices | Designed cloud/Azure-oriented data infrastructure that made heterogeneous analytical datasets easier to retrieve, validate, and reuse

2024
|
2017

• PhD Research

Integrative Ecology Lab, Sherbrooke, Canada

Formulated, implemented, and validated mathematical/statistical models for forest dynamics, including Bayesian hierarchical models, simulation workflows, regression-style evaluation, and historical-data routines for noisy, biased, incomplete data | Extracted signal from large historical datasets by harmonizing field inventories, climate, satellite, and spatial covariates into modelling-ready inputs with explicit assumptions and validation checks | Ran thousands of simulations on HPC infrastructure () to test algorithmic assumptions, compare model behavior, and scale analyses beyond local compute | Developed open-source software libraries (, ) for demographic modelling with version control, automated testing, documentation, and reusable workflows | Published a **technical methods book** documenting the full computational pipeline, along with one peer-reviewed **publication** and two preprints (, )

2022
|
2020
(part-time)

• Biostatistician

Environment and Climate Change Canada - Quebec, Canada

Developed a cost-aware probability sampling protocol to improve the spatial representativeness of boreal bird surveys in Quebec under operational constraints | Led client-facing R&D on spatial bias-correction methods for large-scale ecological monitoring data, translating requirements into a method later adopted by other provinces | Engineered a fully automated and reproducible **data pipeline** with version-controlled workflows, automated documentation, and stakeholder-ready analytical outputs

EDUCATION

2024
|
2017

• PhD, Ecology

Université de Sherbrooke - Sherbrooke, Canada

 *How climate, competition, and forest management shape the limits of tree species distributions: from individuals to metapopulations*

2016
|
2015

• Masters 2, Agroecology and Resource Management

Bordeaux Sciences Agro, Bordeaux, France

 *Modelling the dispersion of weed species in agricultural landscapes*

2015
|
2010

• BSc in Agronomy

Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina, Florianópolis, Brazil

CONTACT

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 [LinkedIn/WillVieira](#)

 [GitHub/WillVieira](#)

 [Publications](#)

SKILLS

Statistics & Decision Analytics:

Regression · Bayesian inference · Hierarchical models · Predictive modelling · Model validation · Uncertainty · Anomaly investigation

Programming & Database:

Python · R · SQL · Stan · Julia · DuckDB · Bash

Data Engineering & Reporting:

ETL/ELT · Data modelling · Data cleaning · BI-ready reporting · APIs · Azure · AWS · Docker · Parquet · HPC

DevOps & Reproducibility:

Git · CI/CD · Unix · Unit testing · Make · Quarto · Jupyter · Automated validation

OUTREACH

· Developed and maintained the **QCBS R Workshop Series**, reaching nearly one thousand graduate students · Taught programming, statistics, SQL, and reproducible workflows to 250+ students across biology, engineering, and graduate programs · Translated stakeholder needs into technical analyses, documented pipelines, and clear analytical outputs

LANGUAGES

Portuguese · Native
French · Full Professional
English · Full Professional

 [Source](#) ·  [HTML](#) ·  [PDF](#)

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